



OPPOSITION ANALYSIS

FEYENOORD

Feyenoord are a controlled, left-loading possession side. They overwhelm you with volume and finish ruthlessly, but they rarely counter, and the clearest chances they give up come when their own build-up is pressed and turned over.

SCOUTING WINDOW

Eredivisie 2022/23 · matchdays 1 to 10 · 10 matches (7 Aug to 16 Oct 2022)

Source: Opta F24 event data and F7 line-ups. Every metric computed from the raw feeds.



PREPARED BY

Mats van Eijk



7-2-1	26-11	58%	18.7	1.83	26	9.7	1.21
W-D-L	GOALS	POSSESSION	SHOTS/GAME	XG/GAME	GOALS (18.3 XG)	SHOTS CONCEDED/G	XGA/GAME

FIVE THINGS THAT DECIDE THE GAME

1. Make it a transition game, because they will not

They keep 58% of the ball, yet they managed a single fast-break shot in ten games. This is a control side, not a counter side. A patient passing contest is exactly what they want, so the more we turn the match into repeated transitions, the more uncomfortable they become.

3. Their threat runs down the left

Forty-one per cent of their final-third entries and 58% of their crosses come from the left, where Hancko and the left-back build and Idrissi isolates one-against-one. We overload our defensive right and we never leave our right-back on his own.

5. The box is a battleground at both ends

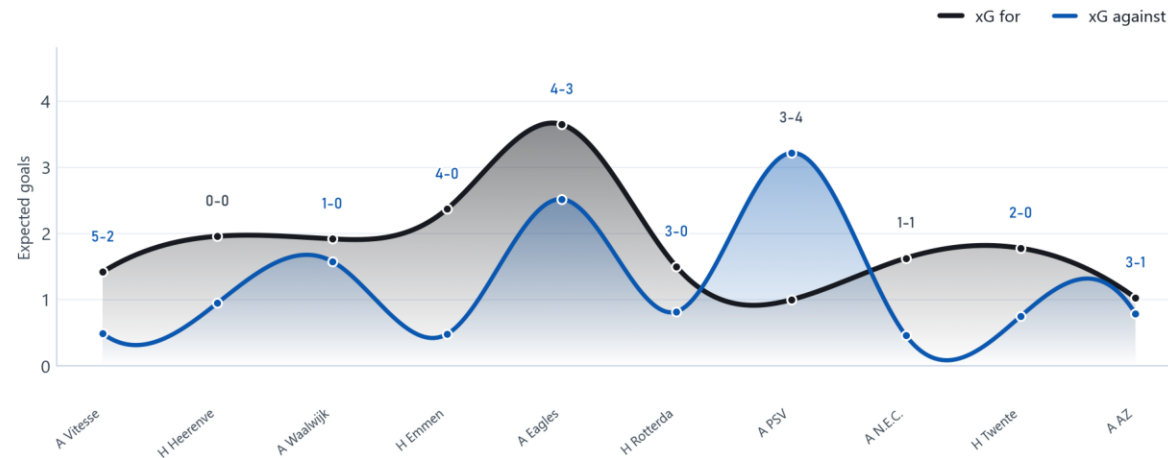
They scored five set-piece goals and conceded three. Their corners come mainly from the left and are aimed at the near post, and their open-play crossing finds a team-mate only a quarter of the time, so defending our box and threatening theirs both pay off.

2. Press their build-up, that is where they crack

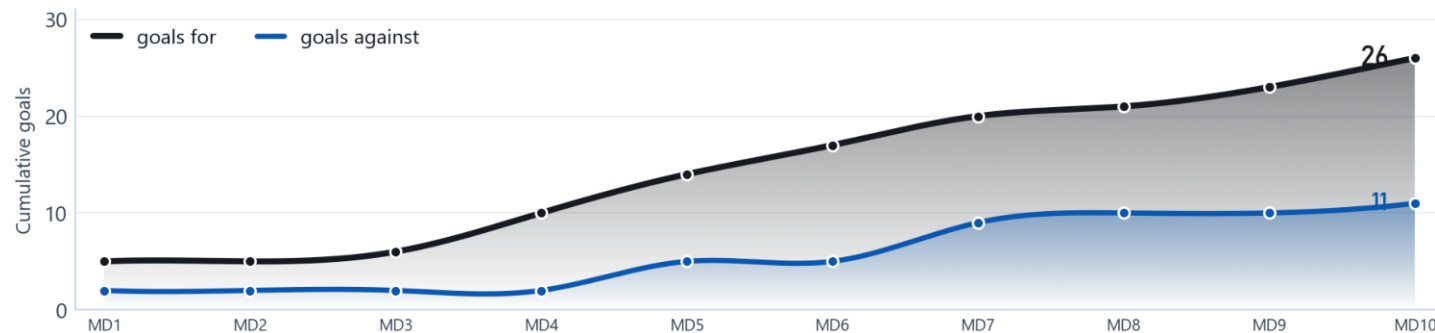
Almost a third of the shots they concede (3.9 xGA) arrive within fifteen seconds of a Feyenoord turnover, and those turnovers happen in their own half. Win the ball high and a clear chance usually follows, so we commit to pressing the first phase rather than sitting off.

4. Strike early, because they own the late game

The only fifteen-minute window where they are out-chanced is 15 to 30 minutes (2.9 xGA, four conceded). After the hour they are ruthless: twelve goals scored, one conceded. Landing the first blow matters more against this side than against most.



Expected goals, match by match



KEY INSIGHT

They control games and out-create everyone, beat them only in open, transitional matches.

- xG sits above xGA in 8 of 10 games, a passing contest favours them.
- The only cracks: PSV (3.22 xGA, lost) and Go Ahead (2.52), both open and end-to-end.
- Two shapes (4-2-3-1 / 4-3-3), one constant: Kökçü as the deepest pivot.

7-2-1

W-D-L

1.83

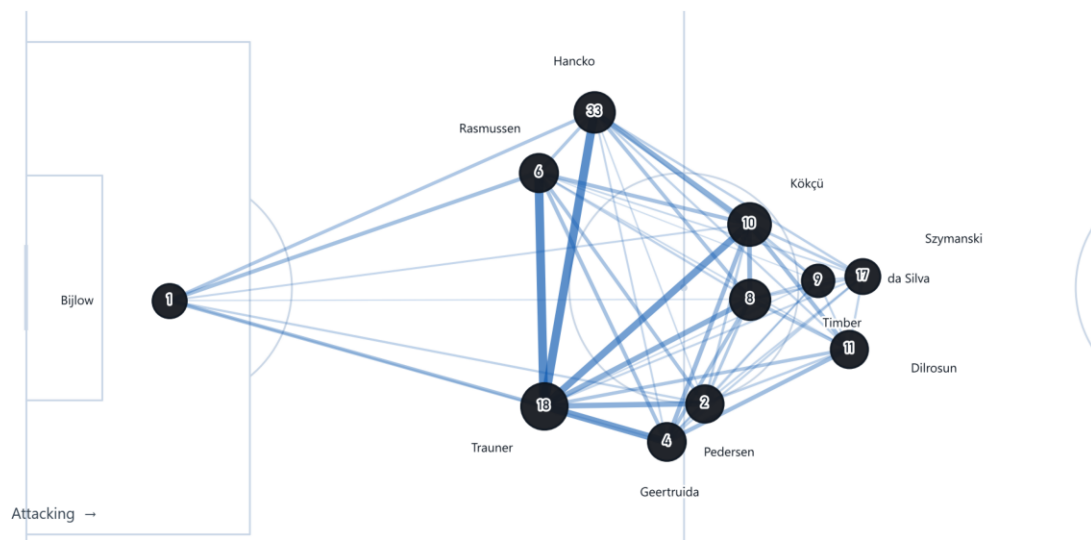
XG/GAME

26-11

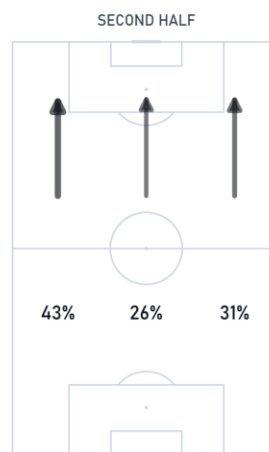
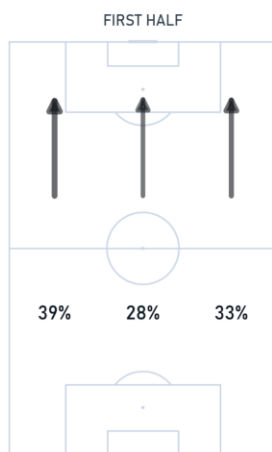
GOALS

1.21

XGA/GAME



Average positions (build-up shape) · 1



KEY INSIGHT

They play through you and load the LEFT, cut Kökçü's time and crowd that channel.

- ▶ Only 10% long balls, patient build via Trauner/Hancko, Kökçü dropping in.
- ▶ 41% of final-third entries and 58% of crosses come down the left.
- ▶ 18.9 crosses/game but just 25% completed, defend the box and live with it.

58%

POSSESSION

22.1

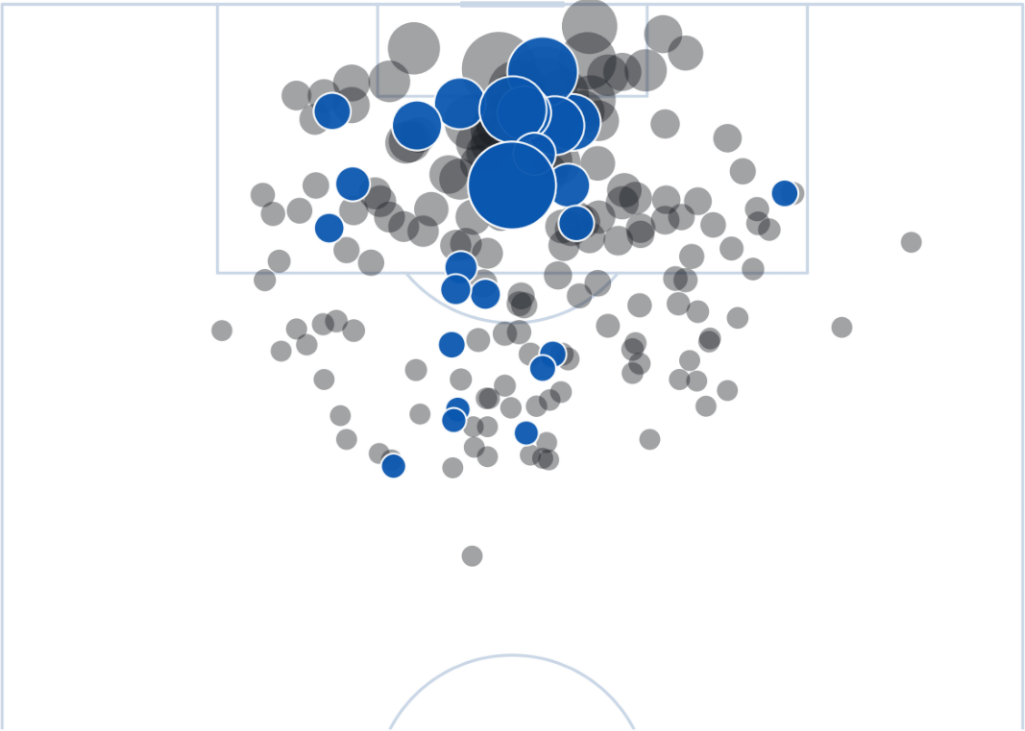
PROG PASSES/G

18.9

CROSSES/G

25%

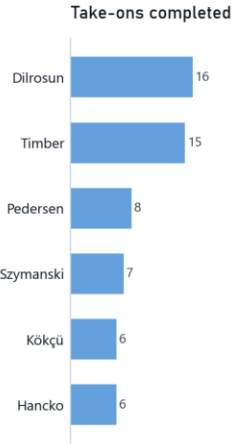
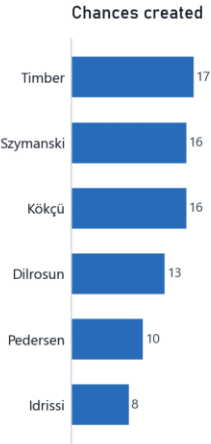
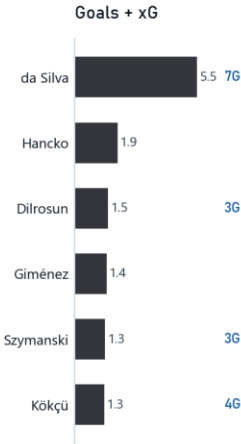
CROSSES DONE



Every shot · size = xG · blue = goals

KEY INSIGHT

Manufactured central chances and clinical finishing, deny the cutback and the half-space.

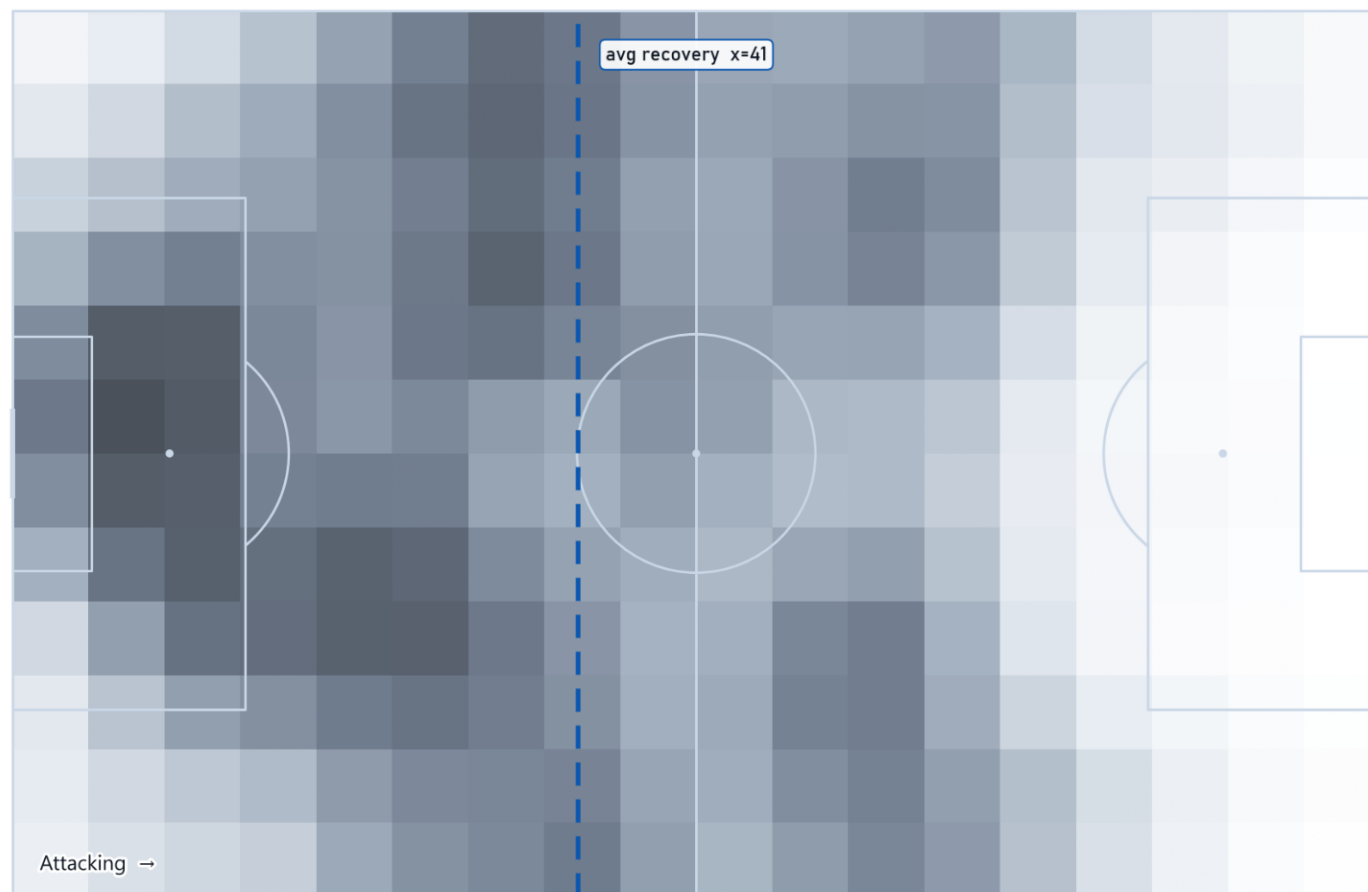


Goals + xG panel: bars = xG · blue number = goals scored





PPDA 10.8 · high turnovers 6.8/game · def-third actions 42.2%



Defensive actions heat · blue line = avg recovery height

KEY INSIGHT

They invite you in and counter, slow build lets them re-set, so play vertical and fast.

- ▶ PPDA 10.8, only 14.5% of defensive actions in the attacking third.
- ▶ Recoveries average around halfway, controlled, not frantic.
- ▶ We WILL get the ball in our half; the question is how quickly we use it.

10.8

PPDA

x41

AVG RECOVERY

42%

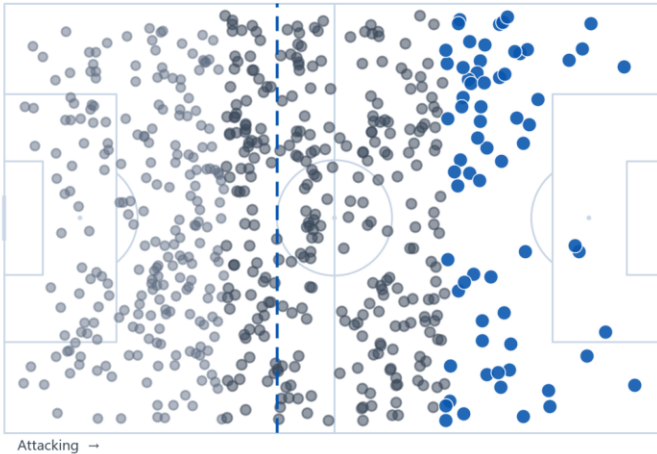
ACTIONS DEF THIRD

6.8

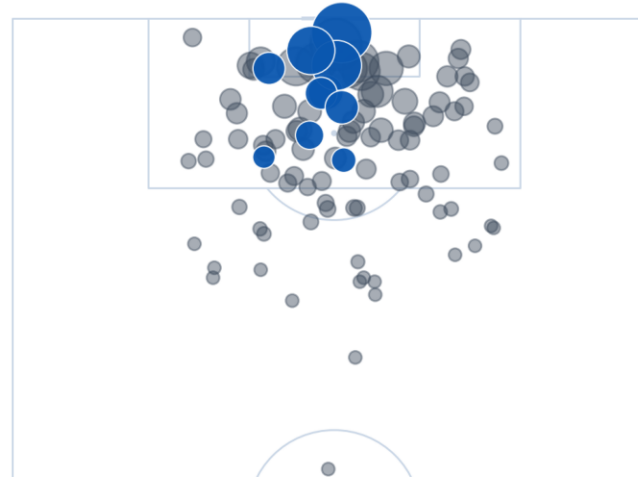
HIGH TURNOVERS/G



WHERE THEY WIN IT BACK · blue = high turnovers



WHERE THEY GET PUNISHED · blue = goals conceded



Left: where they regain · Right: where they get punished

KEY INSIGHT

Their high line and committed full-backs are the door, win it and go, fast, in behind.

- ▶ They concede a higher xG PER SHOT than they create (0.124 vs 0.098).
- ▶ 72% of shots conceded are inside the box, almost all on transition.
- ▶ PSV (3.22 xGA) and Go Ahead (2.52) exploited exactly this.

0.124

XGA/SHOT

72%

CONCEDED IN BOX

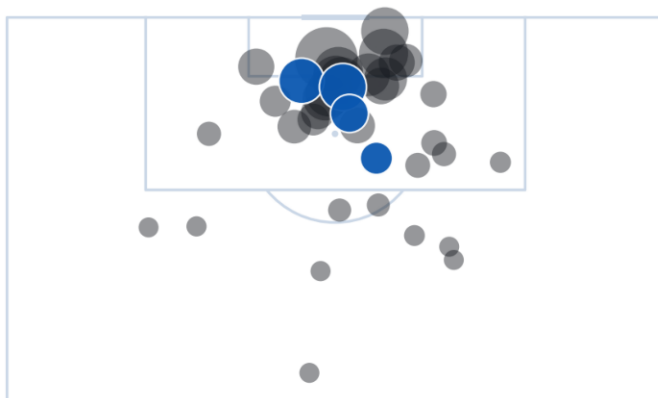
68

HIGH RECOVERIES

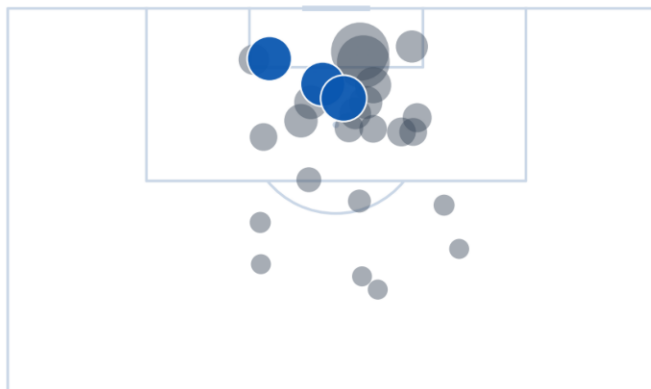
10

GOALS CONCEDED

THREAT • 39 shots / 5 goals / 5.8 xG



CONCEDED • 26 shots / 3 goals / 3.1 xG



Set-piece shots, threat (left) and conceded (right)

KEY INSIGHT

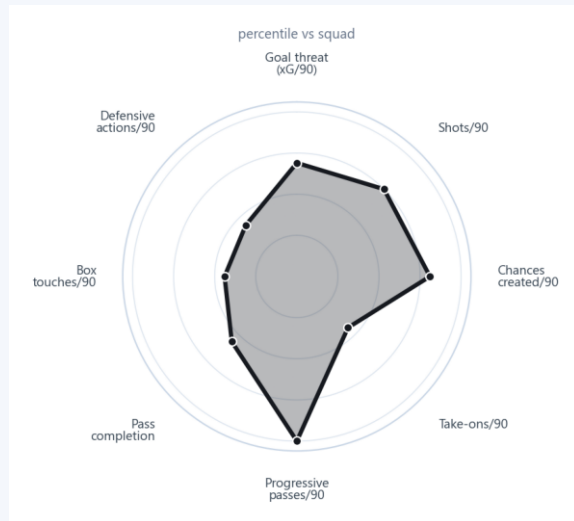
A genuine route to goal for us, and a moment we must defend with full numbers.

- ▶ ~1 in 5 of their shots is from a set piece (39 shots, 5 goals, 5.8 xG).
- ▶ Trauner and Hancko attack the box; Kökçü delivers.
- ▶ But they conceded 3 set-piece goals in 10 games, load the box, far post.

5	3
SP GOALS FOR	SP GOALS AGAINST
39	26
SP SHOTS FOR	SP SHOTS AGAINST

Orkun Kökçü

10 · Deep pivot

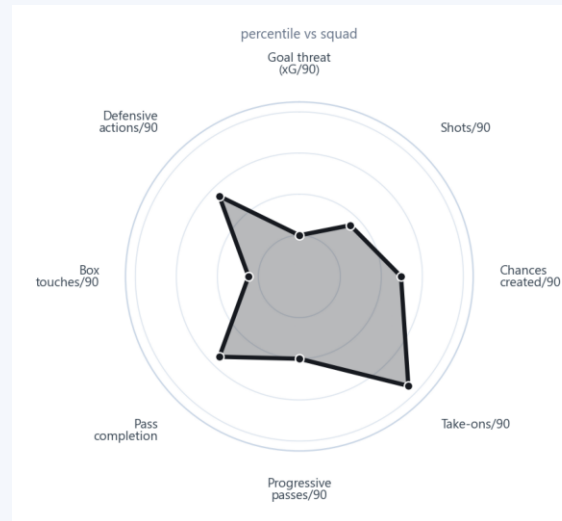


The heartbeat of the side: 888 touches, a team-high 39 progressive passes, 16 chances and four goals, plus the set pieces. He drops to receive around halfway, just left of centre. Get tight and stop him turning, and the build-up slows right down.

688 mins in window

Quinten Timber

8 · Box-to-box



Their best one-against-one player (27 take-ons at 56%) and top creator from deep with 17 chances, across 924 minutes. He covers ground and arrives in the box. Whoever marks him has to track his forward runs, not just his starting position.

924 mins in window

Sebastian Szymański

17 · Attacking mid

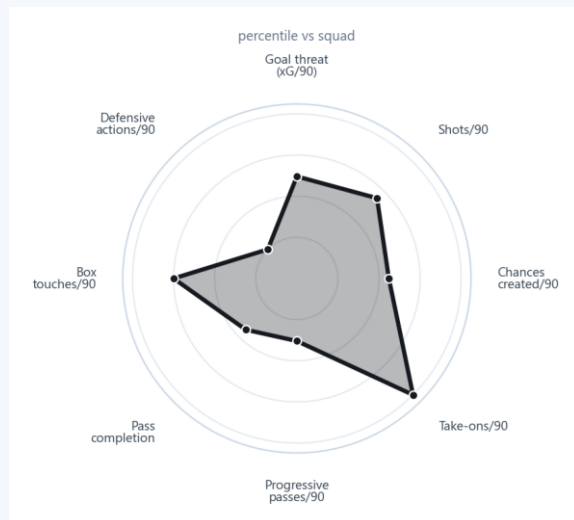


Plays between the lines and drifts to the left. Three goals, 16 chances created, take-ons landing at 50%. A midfielder has to pick him up in the half-space before he turns, because once he is facing our goal he hurts you.

558 mins in window

Javairô Dilrosun

11 · Roaming forward

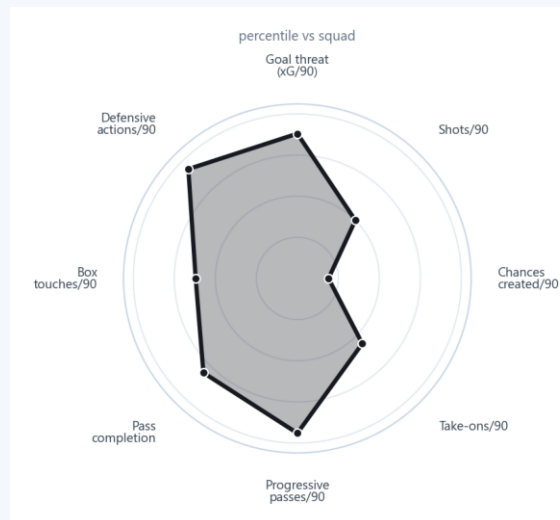


A high-volume dribbler who roams across the front, on average slightly to the right. He tries plenty (46 take-ons) but lands only 35%, with a team-high 49 box touches. Stay patient, show him inside and deny the entry rather than diving in.

813 mins in window

Dávid Hancko

33 · Left centre-back

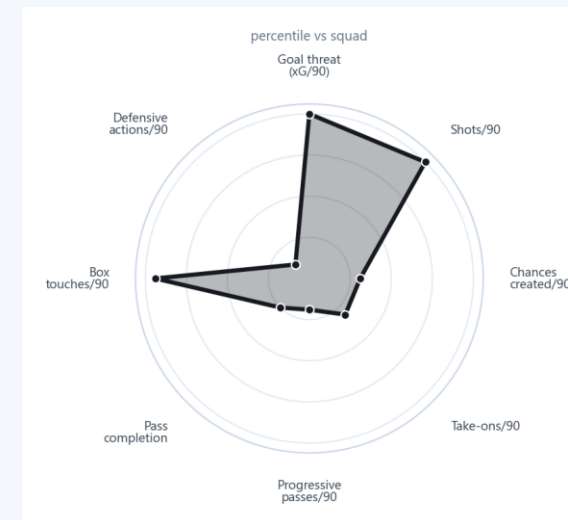


The engine of the left-sided build-up and their second most progressive passer, with a set-piece threat too (1.9 xG). He steps into midfield to move the ball, and the space he leaves behind is exactly where we want to attack in transition.

614 mins in window

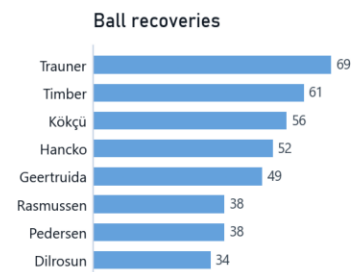
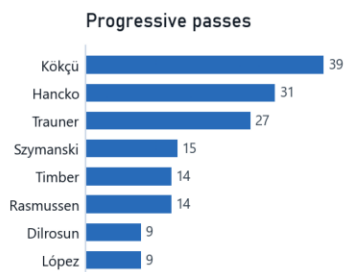
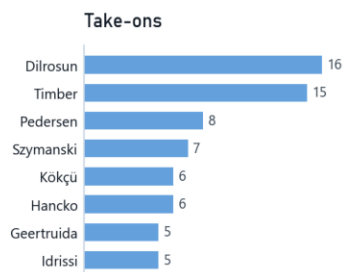
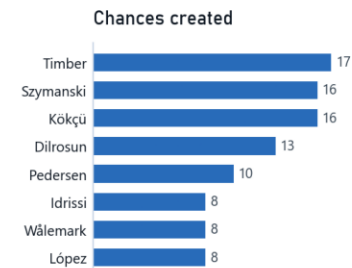
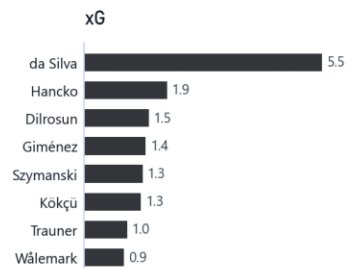
Danilo Pereira da Silva

9 · Striker



Their main finisher, seven goals from 5.45 xG, living on the last shoulder. Disciplined depth from our centre-backs is essential. Giménez is the like-for-like off the bench, so the threat barely changes when he comes on.

597 mins in window



KEY INSIGHT

Threat is shared, but the creative load runs through a small core.

- Kökçü & Hancko drive progression; Timber & Szymański create.
- Dilrosun is the dribble threat; Danilo the focal finisher.
- Depth is real, Giménez, Wålemark, Idrissi all contribute off the bench.



WITH THE BALL

- ▶ Win it and go. Nearly a third of the shots they concede begin with a turnover in their half.
- ▶ Front-load the game: target the 15 to 30 minute window and do not bank on chasing them late.
- ▶ Attack the channel Hancko vacates when he steps in, with a runner breaking from our right.
- ▶ Use our set pieces. They concede from them, so rehearse far-post and second-phase routines.

WITHOUT THE BALL

- ▶ Press their first phase. Trigger on the pass back to Trauner or Bijlow and screen the lane into Kökçü.
- ▶ Force them to cross from deep on the left, then win the box, both first contact and second ball.
- ▶ No isolated duels for our right-back against their left; the winger tracks the overlapping back.
- ▶ Hold a connected mid-block. They barely counter, so the danger is sustained pressure, not balls in behind.

IN-GAME SCENARIOS

If they set up in 4-3-3

Their sharper, more left-loaded shape (2.07 xG a game, 43% of entries left). Double up on that side and use a spare man to jump Kökçü. They press less here (PPDA 12.2), so we can afford to build.

If we go in front

Stay in the block, manage the set pieces and keep the press triggers live on their build-up. Do not drop so deep that we invite the sustained pressure they thrive on.

If they set up in 4-2-3-1

More balanced but leakier (1.34 xGA) and they press higher (PPDA 9.7), which leaves space behind. Bait the press and release runners early into the channels.

First half-hour, or after a goal

Their soft window is 15 to 30 minutes, so start fast and try to take an early lead. The closing stages belong to them: twelve goals after the hour, only one conceded.



Here is how I would feed this into the week: the right information, to the right people, in the right format, at the right time. The players get less, sharper and more visual as the match approaches, and never more than three messages a day once we are out on the grass.

MD-4

Staff alignment

The full dossier goes to the head coach and assistants, and we agree the game-model response: the press triggers on their build-up, our block height, the set-piece plans and the early-game intent. We lock the three or four headline messages we will drip to the players. No player video yet; we align the staff story first.

MD-3

Team, out of possession

An eight to ten minute squad meeting on one theme: how they build and where they crack. A short clip reel of Kökçü dropping in, the left-sided overload and turnovers that became shots. The single ask is to press the build-up, screen Kökçü, force them left and win the box. The back line and keeper get their own unit meeting on the space in behind.

MD-2

Team, in possession and transition

Our route to goal: clips of turnovers won in their half and the space behind Hancko's steps, then we train it with transition-to-finish drills that mirror their shape. Wingers and full-backs get an individual clip pack on their direct opponent (Idrissi, the high left-back, Pedersen).

MD-1

Set pieces and individuals

A set-piece meeting both ways: our near-post marking against Trauner and Hancko, and our own attacking routines against their box defence. Individual clips of 60 to 90 seconds go to the players who need them, personal and focused on their direct duel. Keep it light and confident.

MD

Reminders only

No new information today. A one-page visual in the dressing room with the three keys: press their build-up, force them left and win the box, and strike early. Thirty-second individual reminders. Live from the bench we flag whether they are in 4-3-3 or 4-2-3-1 and adjust.



THEIR THREAT

- ▶ Left-loading possession side (58% ball, 18.7 shots/g)
- ▶ Build through Kökçü; left overload (41% entries, 58% crosses)
- ▶ Clinical: 26 goals from 18.3 xG · 28 big chances
- ▶ Set-piece danger: 5 SP goals (Trauner, Hancko)

THEIR WEAKNESS

- ▶ Concede few but HIGH-quality chances (0.124 xGA/shot)
- ▶ 72% of shots conceded inside the box, on transition
- ▶ High line + committed full-backs = space in behind
- ▶ 3 set-piece goals conceded in 10 games

OUR PLAN

- ▶ Win-it-and-go: attack in behind the full-backs FAST
- ▶ Make it transitional, not a possession contest
- ▶ Compact block, screen Kökçü, force them to cross from deep
- ▶ Win the box both ends, set pieces are our route

THE 3 KEYS

1 · FORCE THEM LEFT & DEFEND THE BOX 2 · WIN-IT-AND-GO IN BEHIND 3 · WIN SET PIECES BOTH ENDS



HOW THIS WAS BUILT

Every figure and number in this dossier is computed directly from the raw Opta F24 event feeds and F7 line-ups for Feyenoord's first ten Eredivisie 2022/23 matches, with no third-party aggregations. The pitch convention is stated and checked: a y value above 66.7 is the attacking left, verified against known left and right-sided players. Expected goals uses a transparent distance-and-angle model with adjustments for headers and set pieces, calibrated so the average shot in the sample is worth roughly the league-typical 0.11. Feyenoord's own shots average 0.098. Goal totals are quoted as match results (26 for, 11 against); the shot-event feed attributes 27 and 10, the small difference being own goals.

WHAT I'D ADD WITH MORE TIME / DATA

- ▶ Tracking & possession data to quantify pressing triggers and line height.
- ▶ Full-season sample to separate stable patterns from noise.
- ▶ Linked Sportscode clips for every figure, one click to the moment.
- ▶ Opponent-specific set-piece pack, frame by frame.

KEY CLIPS TO PULL

Goals conceded, the transition template

A Vitesse	18:58	Manhoef	· open play
A Vitesse	55:05	Frederiksen	· open play
A Go Ahead Eagles	12:51	Lidberg	· open play
A Go Ahead Eagles	95:13	Edvardsen	· open play
A PSV	15:46	Branthwaite	· set piece
A PSV	24:47	Gakpo	· open play
A PSV	46:15	Til	· open play
A PSV	82:39	Obispo	· set piece

Their goals, patterns to defend

A Vitesse	30:26	Wålemark	· open play
A Vitesse	40:18	da Silva	· set piece
A Vitesse	60:06	Dilrosun	· open play
A Vitesse	65:03	da Silva	· open play
A Vitesse	68:22	Geertruida	· open play
A RKC Waalwijk	67:55	da Silva	· open play
H FC Emmen	59:21	Timber	· open play
H FC Emmen	84:13	Giménez	· open play